

Write to the Editor

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Digit will publish the best letters on these pages. Letters may be edited for clarity. Please include your complete address in all communication.

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Inbox

LETTER
OF THE
MONTH

decide to buy another magazine such as *Chip* or *PC World*. However, past experiences have always left me disappointed, and I have to stick to *Digit*. The software content and the magazine, especially QnA, rock. I want to thank you guys for all the information you provide and hope you will keep it coming.

My biggest complaint, if any, is that you guys are more expensive than the other magazines, but *chalega*. Please try and provide some hardware and networking content as I'm studying that. Is there any way in which I can get the issues I've missed?

Hidayath Khan S
Mysore

Dear Hidayath,

Thanks for your mail and all the appreciation of *Digit*. Yes, *Digit* costs you more than the rest, but we pack in a lot more. Regarding previous *Fast Track* issues, if you bought our December 2006 issue, you will find that the Archive CD contains the past 23 issues (2 years) of *Digit* and all 21 issues of *Fast track* in PDF format.

So go grab that issue from a newsstand that might still have it, and keep mailing us your feedback and suggestions!

— Executive Editor

Whoops!

I am a regular reader of *Digit*. I want to report a mistake in your November 2006 *Fast Track To Open Source Software*, page 40 - 41, under *Formats, Codecs & Other Undecipherable Stuff*.

In The PAL section, you define "PAL—Phase Alteration Line, a format of video display used in India. This is made up of 600 lines refreshed at 25fps." PAL is actually 625 lines, 25fps, 50 Hz.

Santosh Kumar

December Was Bad

Guys, I'm a reader of *Digit* since your very first issue. I was really disappointed with your CD contents in the special issue of December. You guys say that most PC owners use Windows, but you gave two whole CDs on Linux. The DVD and CD were also not that great, but your interface is superb.

Sumit Uniyal
Jaipur

Dear Sumit,

Have you tried dyne:bolic? It's amazingly useful and a lot of fun for a lot of people.

Though we have got hundreds of mails thanking us for it, we're sorry you didn't like it. Besides, it's not like you need to format your Windows installation to use it (or even Slax), because they are Live CDs.

The other CD you are mentioning contained our Digit Archive—23 past issues of *Digit* and all 21 past issues of the *Fast Track* series of books. We're also sorry that you did not like the rest of the content, and we hope you will keep writing to us and give us suggestions about what to include.

You can also log on to the Digit Forum at www.thinkdigit.com/forum, visit the "By Demand section" and *demand* all the software you want. We make every effort to fulfil all reasonable demands.

— Executive Editor

Wah, Wah

Hum aapki magazine se khafaa nahi ho sakte,

Vaada kiya hai ise kahirdne ka isliye bewafa nahi ho sakte.

Aap hume jaante hon ya nahi,
Hum aapki magazine ko padhe bina reh nahi sakte.

I am a student of class 10, and I love your magazine. I have started reading *Digit* from September 2006, and though I'm not a subscriber, I never miss an issue. All the stuff that you give away in your CD and DVD are very useful. All the tests (motherboards, graphics cards, etc.), Bazaar, game reviews, etc., are great.

I especially like the reviews of extraordinary stuff in *Droolmaal*. *Digit* keeps me updated through the latest technology, and has Digitized me. Are you giving fast track to Flash in the future? Once more, thanks for the coolest magazine I've ever read...

Puranjai Pratap Mall
Kanpur

It's been a year since I started buying *Digit*. I used to read *Chip* and then *Computers@home*, and now I'm stuck with *Digit*. I buy from the newsstand, but once I'm settled, I will be taking a three-year subscription. Before reading your *Fast Track to Google*, I had no idea that Google had so many services!

Radeesh
Chennai

Dear Puranjai and Radeesh,

We're glad to have made an impression. We hope you enjoy *Digit* for many more years.

— Executive Editor

Paranoia!

I read through your editorial in January's issue, and I am also very uncomfortable with the current situation. The first time I saw the movie *Enemy of the state*, I was horrified. I knew that the technology featured in the movie was not all yet in existence, but the keyword remains yet.

Soon, corporate powerhouses, governments, etc., will be able to access and view every aspect of our lives, what we did, when, where, everything. Most of the technologies are available, only the networking of the databases remains—the example of Google's services is testament to this.

But let's get back to the moral / political issue here. Our personal lives are getting invaded, Orkut even could force us to fill out all of our profile details. My solution has been to lie blatantly at all signups. A little example—I am registered as "Krauser Veinel" of "Russia" at Yahoo! My Orkut profile does not have any personal detail except that I am in Delhi and like Eminem and NWA.

I downloaded (illegally, of course) the infamous "Cookbook". For those who do not know, it is a guide to making bombs, hijacking cars, looting banks, digital theft (what irony), etc. Does that make me a potential threat to national security? Legally, the answer is no! And I am a teenager who is attracted to violence and all such things, like most teenagers.

What then justifies the monitoring of a citizen by the state? I do not know. Downloading the "Cookbook" certainly does not. But nothing justifies Google or any other commercial entity to have knowledge of the whole of our lives, or even a small part of it.

Our identity is the only thing we really have. Our job, wealth, friends are all linked to our identity. And as our digital identity becomes more and more important, the chances of it being misused or worse, stolen, increase.

But it's not just that. Hearing the words "they are watching you" is chilling, because it's true. Maybe that's why I never got a credit card, and told my dad to refrain from them, even though ICICI bank nearly tricked me into getting one.

I apologise for this extremely long letter, but I just had to write this. I would also like to remain anonymous.

A Digit Reader